

has been particularly sordid with the world at large reeling under an oppressive economic recession besides being plagued by heightened terrorism, the Conclave has rightfully focused on the ways and means of solving the global financial mess and curtailing the scourge of international terrorism to usher in an era of peace and prosperity.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Political League

Union Home Minister P. Chidambaram has bravely faced all odds ("Crisis After Crisis", March 30). He did not buckle under the BCCI's arm-twisting tactics. The Indian Premier League is not the most important thing in the country and the organisers did the right thing by shifting it to South Africa. The Government gave priority, and rightly so, to the general elections scheduled to be held at the same time. The central paramilitary and state police forces would be stretched to their limits during the elections, and providing fool-proof security for an event like the IPL would have been difficult.

PRANAV SACHDEVA, Delhi

Floods of Misery

The ordeal of the children orphaned by the catastrophic Kosi floods seems unending ("Children for Sale", March 30). They are being bought and sold by

traffickers and the state authority is doing little to save them. Natural disasters cannot be controlled but such miseries can be prevented only if stricter counter-trafficking measures are taken.

PAUL P.J.,
via www.indiatoday.in

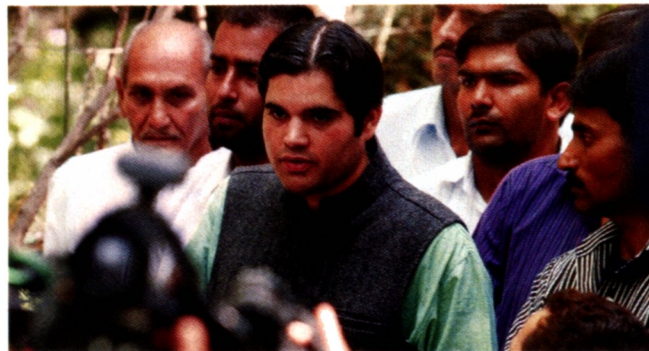
Cyber Smart

True to its image of a party with a difference, the BJP's spin masters are weaving an enticing web to lure young voters ("The Virtual Combat", March 23). By

advantage Advani.
H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Prime Concerns

The Third Front will run into a big problem because of the overriding ambitions of the leaders who have joined hands to grab power at the Centre, if none of the two major parties manage to get the required score ("Repeat Value", March 9). Almost all the party chiefs of the constituent parties want to become the prime min-



“ Varun Gandhi's vitriolic speech has landed him in a political quagmire. And the worst part is that there seems no respite from any corner—neither from his party nor from the law.”

PADMINI RAGHAVENDRA, via www.indiatoday.in

webbing and blogging, the party has made a big splash in the cyberspace. It is a big hit with young Netizens who just need to log in themselves to know more about BJP leader L.K. Advani. Though other politicians are trying hard to match Advani's cyber pace, only a few have succeeded. In the poll bout, it is indeed

ister. The BSP's Mayawati has already withdrawn and intends to throw her hat into the ring after the elections if she manages enough seats to dictate terms. Some others who aspire to be the prime minister may soon follow suit, leaving the newly-formed Third Front in tatters.

R.J. KHURANA, Bhopal

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30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

MAY 16-31, 1979

An Empire in Turmoil

At an age when most of his contemporaries are contemplating the hereafter, Ram Nath Goenka, 77, proprietor of one of India's biggest newspaper empires, is attempting his most ambitious plan of expansion. With his mammoth network of 35 newspapers and magazines—including the 10-edition, English-language *Indian Express*—Goenka might not be the richest newspaper tycoon around, but he is certainly the most powerful. Over 45 years after he established his first Tamil daily in Madras, Goenka has survived more battles and controversies than any high-flying industrialist could boast of. And he can exert more influence through his nationwide chain of newspapers than any government would like to admit. "There is," Goenka points out, "no man in this country except me who started and built his own newspaper empire, as people call it."

Sunil Sethi with Prabhu Chawla



GOENKA